STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3432
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **03/03/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT EMERGENCY MEDICAL HELICOPTER	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for requesting and assisting with an emergency medical helicopter.

II. Policy:

The Omaha metropolitan area has the benefit of two trauma centers. Both trauma centers have emergency medical helicopters and crews available to them. In the event of serious trauma it is essential to transport a victim to a trauma center as rapidly as possible. In many cases this may be accomplished with the use of a medical helicopter. Flight crews are also able to provide advanced medical support.

Deputies responding to rescue calls need to assess victims of trauma, and when responding medical units have not arrived, may request the emergency medical helicopter if they feel that the victim would benefit from a rapid transport. Request for service may also be made by an off-duty deputy should the need arise. The Sheriff's Office has established guidelines to request helicopter service and responsibilities when the request has been made.

III. Procedures:

A. Requesting Emergency Helicopter-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. If a deputy determines an individual has suffered major trauma, he or she may request an emergency helicopter. Major trauma includes, but is not limited to:

a) Major head injuries.
b) Gunshot wounds.
c) Stabbing to the trunk area.

d) Total or near amputation of an extremity.

2. The deputy shall provide his or her assessment of the patient to dispatch. This assessment must include but may not be limited to:

a) Any breathing problems and number of respirations per minute.
b) Heart rate.
c) Any bleeding.
d) Any deformities (e.g. obvious broken bones).
e) Any apparent neurological damage.
f) Level of consciousness.

3. After giving this assessment to dispatch, the deputy shall maintain his or her care of the patient. The deputy shall remain in charge of the patient until the squad arrives. At this time the squad crew shall take charge of the patient and the patient care.

4. The deputy passing care of the patient shall also pass on any medical documentation regarding the patient to the squad crew to be included on the Nebraska Ambulance Rescue Service Information System (NARSIS) forms.

5. The initial responding deputy is responsible in his or her capacity as a first responder to complete an incident report.

B. Landing an Emergency Helicopter-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. As soon as possible, requesting deputies shall identify a safe landing zone (LZ) for the helicopter. Deputies shall look for a hard, flat surface that is as free of loose debris as possible, overhead wires and any other obstruction that would hinder the landing of the helicopter. The area should be approximately one hundred (100) feet by one hundred (100) feet or larger.

2. Coordinate with the Fire/EMS Incident Commander on assisting with the landing of the helicopter.

3. Deputies may contact the helicopter directly on radio talk group B-5.

4. Once the helicopter has landed the LZ deputies should assist with any request of the flight crew.

C. Emergency Medical Helicopter Use-Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. The on-duty shift supervisor shall brief the watch commander or the A.D.C. on the use of the helicopter for press release purposes.

2. A shift supervisor or responding deputy may also place an emergency medical helicopter on stand-by prior to deputies arriving at a scene where major trauma could reasonably be expected.

D. Cancellation of Emergency Medical Helicopter

1. Once the helicopter has been placed on standby or requested by the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office only the responding deputy, a shift supervisor, command officer, or fire/rescue may cancel the standby or request for service.

2. Cancellation may also take place at the discretion of the pilot or flight crew for unsafe conditions.